Mahindra University **HS 1101 – Module 1**
École Centrale School of Engineering **Worksheet 1.3**

Name: **Roll No:** **Batch:**

Pre-reading Activity

Part A: Respond individually in two sentences:

1. What is the first place that comes to your mind when you hear the word "home"?

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2. Which objects, sounds or smells remind you of home?

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3. Is home only a physical place, or can it also be a feeling, a memory or a person? Elaborate.

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Part B: Discuss the following questions in groups of five. Choose any two questions and be prepared to share your ideas with the class.

1. Why do people fight to protect their homeland?
2. Can someone be separated from their homeland but still feel they belong there?
3. What is the meaning of home in the contemporary world?

Active Reading - As you read the poem, make notes that help you understand.

- Underline words or sentences that seem important.
- Is there a sentence that impacts you the most?
- Highlight one observation from the text.
- Underline any sensory details you observe.

I Belong There - Mahmoud Darwish (1941- 2008)

I belong there. I have many memories. I was born as everyone is born.

I have a mother, a house with many windows, brothers, friends, and a prison cell

with a chilly window! I have a wave snatched by seagulls, a panorama of my own.

I have a saturated meadow. In the deep horizon of my word, I have a moon,

a bird's sustenance, and an immortal olive tree.

I have lived on the land long before swords turned man into prey.

I belong there. When heaven mourns for her mother, I return heaven to her mother.

And I cry so that a returning cloud might carry my tears.

To break the rules, I have learned all the words needed for a trial by blood.

I have learned and dismantled all the words in order to draw from them a

single word: *Home*.

Post Reading

Part I: Finding the Main Idea

1. What is the central idea of the poem?

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Part II: Reading Between the Lines - Respond in two sentences**:**

1. Why does the speaker repeatedly say, "I belong there"?

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2. Why is the final word "Home" italicised? Why do you think the poet ends the poem with this single word?

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Part III: Thinking Critically

1. How has the poem changed or deepened your understanding of the idea of "home"?

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2. Do you think everyone has a fundamental need to belong? Why or why not?

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3. Which image or symbol stayed with you the most? Why?

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4. If you had to leave home, which memories would you carry with you?

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Part IV: Personal Response: Write a short response in 80-100 words.

Describe a place where you feel you truly belong. Explain how this place has shaped your identity using descriptive language and personal memories.

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